

Small updates for the Playbook

The 1.07 update for the Playbook intros "differential updating", allowing for smaller patches for updating the OS

Epson iPrint App

Epson rolls out iPrint app for Android phones; lets you print over Wi-Fi

Give that Android phone a boost, without rooting

Straight out of the box, Android phones aren't the best performing ones around. Mostly because of the badly optimised customisations handset manufacturers tend to wrap around the OS - to make it look better, add more features (usually a bunch of widgets) etc. Google agrees with this too - No customisations allowed on Android 3.0.

However, what you're left with is a smartphone that has the potential to work a lot better than it actually does. After all, isn't "potential performance" what you paid that whole lot of money for? Fret



not, here are a few basic tricks (more like alternate app installations) you can try. Trust us, the smartphone will truly feel like an unleashed beast.

LauncherPro: Handset manufacturer home screens don't always have all the features or looks. And the likes of

HTC Sense tend to look good, but at the cost of performance. Launcher Pro is the home screen replacement. Multiple customisation options are available, and we've always seen the phones perform quicker when this is set as the default home screen app - be it on a mid-range

Android smartphone or a dual-core beast.

Download from: <http://goo.gl/LxhDL>

Price: Free (₹160 for Pro Plus to unlock the widgets feature: <http://goo.gl/mXnDZ>)

Alternatives to this alternative: ADWLauncher, SPD 3D Shell Helix Launcher and Launcher 7. All these are available on the Android Market in both - paid and free versions.

Spare Parts: This one is used to enable/disable some hidden features of the Android OS. Tweaks like window animations, input animations, haptic feedback can be tweaked. All these settings do make the Android experience a quicker one.

Download from: <http://goo.gl/djEFo>

Price: Free

APP WATCH

Karma Kingdom: Facebook app for creating a better world

The Gods are now on Facebook. No, they haven't set up any profiles there as yet, but they will be the guiding force in the online game, Karma Kingdom. The real essence behind the game is to allow you to create a completely new world, the perfect world as some may say. The game begins with the user on a completely undeveloped island, but with enough raw materials to put together the building blocks for a future civilisation. Lord Ganesha (the God of Success) guides the player



in setting shelters up first and making food available. Lord Hanuman (the God of Friendship), then takes the charge and guides the player in bringing a sense of compassion, a strength

of healing and draw from collective power in this new world. Goddess Laxmi (the Goddess of Wealth, Knowledge and Happiness) brings in the angle of learning - the learning of peace and happiness, both for the individual and for everyone around. Lord Surya (the God of the Sun) and Lord Chandra (the God of the Moon) team up and introduce quests that help the gamer understand what the needs of the people are and show ways in which to fulfill them. Lord Garuda (the Lord of Defence) teaches the player how to deal with conflicts through a series of tasks.

The game Karma Kingdom essentially tries to teach the ways of an otherwise perfect world, through the route of mythology and a series of successive tasks. What also comes out of this is a far deeper learning of the society around us, something we may or may

not have noticed till now, for whatever reasons.

Play Karma Kingdom on Facebook: <http://goo.gl/qMtIZ>

APP NEWS

Blackberry App World 3.0

RIM (Research In Motion) has finally rolled out the App World 3.0 globally. The new version has a completely redone interface, better app listing and a better reviews and ratings feature for apps. It is available for smartphones running OS5 or higher and the PlayBook tablet. The OTA download should be available on your phone, or you can download it from here:

<http://goo.gl/SaeK>